RESIDENTIAL HALLS

GREEN *Living* GUIDE 2026-2027

YOUR GUIDE TO SUSTAINABLE LIVING IN THE HALLS



AUS Sustainability

AUS American University of Sharjah

SRL STUDENT RESIDENTIAL LIFE



OUR *Pillars*

Climate

Nature & Green Spaces

Energy & Climate

Mobility & Smart Travel

Nature

Waste & Circular Living

Food

Food & Sustainable Cooking

Health

Health & Well-Being

SDG 15*, 3, 11

NATURE & GREEN SPACES

Time outside=Less stress=More focus=Calmer halls



DO

- Take study breaks outdoors.
- Keep windows clear for light/views.

DON'T

- Damage plants or feed wildlife.
- Leave trash in green areas.
- Plant without approval

QUICK WINS

- Add a small desk plant or nature poster.
- Take a 10 min 'green walk' reset.
- Plan picnics with reusables only.

SDG 13*, 6, 7, 11

ENERGY & CLIMATE

Smart energy use=Lower bills=Cooler rooms=Lighter footprint





DO

- Set your AC at 24°C when not in your room
- Run AC with doors/windows closed.
- Turn off lights, unplug chargers.
- Use natural light when you can.
- Report leaks/drips early.
- Wash full loads in cold water.

DON'T

- Run AC with windows open.
- Overstuff fridge so it can't cool.
- Let taps run while brushing teeth, doing dishes, etc.
- Take excessively long showers.
- Do half-loads of laundry.



QUICK WINS

- Put chargers on a power strip, flip OFF when leaving.
- Set laptop/TV to auto sleep.
- Time your shower with a short playlist.

SDG 11*, 3, 13

MOBILITY & TRAVEL

Smarter travel=Less stress=Less money=Less pollution

DO

- Walk, shuttle, bike, or carpool first.
- Plan routes/times to skip traffic.
- Pack light when moving out.

DON'T

- Drive alone for short trips.
- Park bikes/scooters in random spots.
- Dump furniture/e-waste at move-out, donate instead





QUICK WINS

- Save the shuttle timetable on your phone.
- Keep a small 'go kit' (bottle, tote, container).
- Pump bike/scooter tires, better ride.

SDG 12*, 11, 13

WASTE & CIRCULAR LIVING



Less trash=Less mess=More savings

DO

- Use the 3-bin system (paper, plastic, metal)
- Carry a bottle, mug, or tote.
- Borrow or swap before buying new.
- Store food correctly and eat leftovers.

DON'T

- Toss dirty containers in recycling.
- Trash usable items, donate instead.
- Buy single-use products.

QUICK WINS

- Keep a reusables kit (bottle + tote) by the door.
- Flatten boxes, crush bottles, and close lids.
- Put a small give/take box in your corridor.

SDG 12*, 3, 13

FOOD & SUSTAINABILE COOKING

Eat better=Save money=Waste less

DO

- Cook simple, balanced meals.
- Label food with name/date in the fridge.
- Share safe surplus food

DON'T

- Use single-use cutlery when reusables work.
- Leave unsealed food in shared areas.
- Dump edible food.

QUICK WINS

- Precut healthy snacks for late nights.
- Freeze single portions with date labels.
- Refill your water before class & bed.



SDG 3*, 11, 12

HEALTH & WELLBEING

You can’t focus on studies (or the planet) if you’re running on empty.



DO

- Set a screen cutoff before sleep.
- Move daily (walk, stairs, gym).
- Drink water, eat balanced meals.
- Keep halls calm at night.

DON’T

- Make all nighters a habit.
- Scroll endlessly in bed.
- Skip meals or overdo caffeine





QUCK WINS

- Use 'Do Not Disturb' at night.
- Keep a small well-being kit (snack, earplugs, eye mask).
- Stretch/breathe/tidy for a quick reset.